

Mangeshi Temple

One of the oldest temples in the Gomantak region, the Mangeshi Temple (also called Mangueshi) dedicated to Lord Manguesh, an incarnation of Lord Shiva, was originally located in Kushastali (Cortalim). It shifted to Mangeshi village in the mid-16th century following Portuguese persecution. The temple's architecture is an Indo-Portuguese melange, with Goan baroque as well as Dravidian elements. It is famed for its seven-storeyed *deepastambha* (lamp column) and holy water tank.

Where: Dinanath Mangeshkar Road, Mangeshi Village, Ponda, Mardol

Main event: Annual Magh Purnima Jatra, a three-day festival held in February